Voting in Ancient Athens Simulation Workshop (60 minutes)
Goals:
Students are invited to:
- Expand on / refresh their knowledge about the origins of democracy and the voting
process in ancient Athens,
- Participate in a simulation debate following the voting process in ancient Athens.

1. Introduction (5 minutes)
Objectives:
- Activate previous knowledge
- Briefly introduce Ancient Athens and its significance in the history of democracy.

Activity:
- Students brainstorm on the topic
- Teacher presents and explains the concept of democracy, emphasizing its Athenian
origins.

2. The ancient Athenian Voting System (10 minutes)
Objective:
- Enhance students' knowledge on how the ancient Greek voting system worked.

Activities
Presentation:
- Explain the Assembly ("Ekklesia"), where citizens gathered to vote on important issues.
- Describe the process of ostracism, where citizens could vote to exile a person for ten years.
- Highlight the importance of the "Vouli" (Council of 500) and how members were chosen.
- Emphasize the democratic value of equality between Athenian citizens to take the floor.
- Stress the impact on modern society.

3. Simulation Activity (15-20 minutes)
Objectives: Allow students to experience the Athenian voting process, Participate in a debate and enrich argumentative EFL speaking skills, Cultivate acceptance of opposing views.
Activities:
Setup:The teacher:

• Appoints a student as the “state presiding official” to address the audience with the initial proposal to be voted for or against later on.
• Divides students into small groups, each representing different segments of Athenian society (parents-teachers-students-ministry of education officials).
• Gives each group the scenario cards to discuss (“penalty for mobile phone misuse at school”) and sticks team badges to each member.

Simulation:

- Each group discusses their scenario and prepares arguments for and/or against the issue.
- Groups present their arguments to the class.
- Conduct a mock vote (via raising hands) to simulate the ancient voting process. Results exhibited on blackboard, simulating the ancient Athens voting procedure.

4. Discussion: Then and Now (10 minutes)

Objective: Draw parallels between ancient and modern democratic processes.

Activities:

• Facilitate a discussion on the similarities and differences between ancient Athenian democracy and modern democratic systems.
• Discuss the importance of participation in elections today, drawing on historical examples from the workshop.

5. Conclusion and Reflection (10 minutes)

Objective: Summarize the key points and reflect on the activity.

Activities:

•Students share what they learned and how they felt about the voting process.
○
•Whole group talk to emphasize the importance of civic engagement and informed voting in contemporary society.

Materials Needed:

Presentation on Ancient Athens and its democratic processes.
• Props for the simulation activity (microphone, class projector, presiding official’s introductory speech, scenario cards, team badges).**Appendix I – Introductory Presentation**
https://prezi.com/p/q1u4d8mr1ke-/?present=1

«Με την επιχορήγηση της Ευρωπαϊκής Ένωσης. Ωστόσο, οι απόψεις και οι γνώμες που διατυπώνονται εκφράζουν αποκλειστικά τις απόψεις των συντακτών και δεν αντιπροσωπεύουν κατ’ ανάγκη τις απόψεις της Ευρωπαϊκής Ένωσης ή του Ιδρύματος Κρατικών Υποτροφιών (ΙΚΥ). Ούτε η Ευρωπαϊκή Ένωση ούτε η χορηγούσα αρχή μπορούν να θεωρηθούν υπεύθυνες για αυτές.»